

FREE GUIDE · 2026

2026 Scholarships & Funding Guide

Fully-funded scholarships, proof-of-funds by country, education loans, a month-by-month timeline and money-saving tips — everything to fund your study abroad.

100% free · no signup

Top fully-funded scholarships (1/2)

DAAD — Germany

Germany's academic exchange service funds international master's & PhD students with tuition support plus a monthly living stipend. Deadlines vary by programme; apply early through the DAAD scholarship database.

Chevening — UK

The UK government's flagship award fully funds a one-year master's (tuition, living, travel). Applications typically open August–November. Strong leadership and work experience matter.

Commonwealth Scholarships — UK

Full funding for students from eligible Commonwealth (mostly developing) countries, applied via your national nominating agency.

Fulbright — USA

Prestigious full funding for master's/PhD study in the US; apply roughly 12–15 months before intake through your country's Fulbright commission.

Erasmus Mundus — EU

Fully-funded joint master's degrees across multiple European universities, including tuition, a monthly allowance and travel. Deadlines usually December–February.

Top fully-funded scholarships (2/2)

| **Australia Awards — Australia**

Australian-government scholarships covering full tuition and living costs for students from eligible partner countries.

| **Manaaki New Zealand Scholarships**

New Zealand-government full scholarships for students from selected countries, covering tuition, living and travel.

| **Vanier CGS — Canada**

CAD 50,000 per year for doctoral study in Canada; you must be nominated by the Canadian university.

| **Gates Cambridge — UK**

Full-cost scholarship to study at the University of Cambridge, with one main application round per year.

| **Knight-Hennessy Scholars — USA**

Full funding for any graduate programme at Stanford University; highly competitive, single annual deadline.

| **Tip**

Most universities also offer their own merit scholarships — always check the university's financial-aid page after you get admission.

Proof of funds by country (2026)

I How much you must show

Germany: about EUR 11,904/year in a blocked account (Sperrkonto), ~EUR 992/month, via Fintiba or Expatrio.

Canada: about CAD 20,635 via a GIC for the SDS study-permit stream, returned to you in instalments after arrival.

UK: about GBP 1,334/month (London) or GBP 1,023/month (elsewhere) for up to 9 months, held 28 days.

Australia: about AUD 29,710/year in living costs as financial evidence under the Genuine Student requirement.

Ireland: about EUR 10,000/year shown to immigration. USA: the first-year cost of attendance for your university (varies).

I Always verify

These figures change yearly. Confirm the current amount on the official immigration website before you apply or transfer money. Full live table: landingprep.com/study-abroad-funding-facts-2026/

Loans, timeline & money-saving tips

Education loans

Secured (with collateral) loans are typically ~8.5–11% p.a. — the cheapest option. Unsecured/no-collateral loans are ~11–15% p.a. with a per-lender limit. Most loans have a moratorium covering your course plus 6–12 months; paying the simple interest during study cuts the total a lot. Compare lenders on rate, limit and EMI.

Month-by-month timeline

15–12 months: shortlist universities, book your English/standardised test.
12–9: take tests, draft SOP/LORs, apply for scholarships. 9–6: submit applications. 6–3: accept an offer, arrange funds (blocked account/GIC/loan). 3–1: apply for your visa, book accommodation and flights.

Money-saving tips

Apply to a few scholarships in parallel; pick countries with low/zero tuition (e.g. Germany) where you only fund living costs; work part-time (most student visas allow ~20 hours/week); use free prep instead of paid coaching; and budget a 2–3% buffer for currency-conversion loss on transfers.

Now go from funding to campus — free

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